Weekly cetuximab

One larger first infusion is followed by weekly infusions. Bowel-cancer treatment continues while helping and tolerated. For head-and-neck treatment, cetuximab starts one week before radiotherapy and continues until radiation treatment finishes.

Source reconciled; independent clinical, pharmacy and patient/PPI review pending. Selected effects; not a complete medicine leaflet.

A picture of side effects

Numbered symptom boxes connect to the anatomical illustration. The medicine responsible may be uncertain; report the symptom.

1 Eyes

Cetuximab

Eye pain or new visual change needs prompt advice.

2 Blood minerals

Cetuximab

Tests check magnesium and other minerals even when you feel well.

3 Breathing / reaction

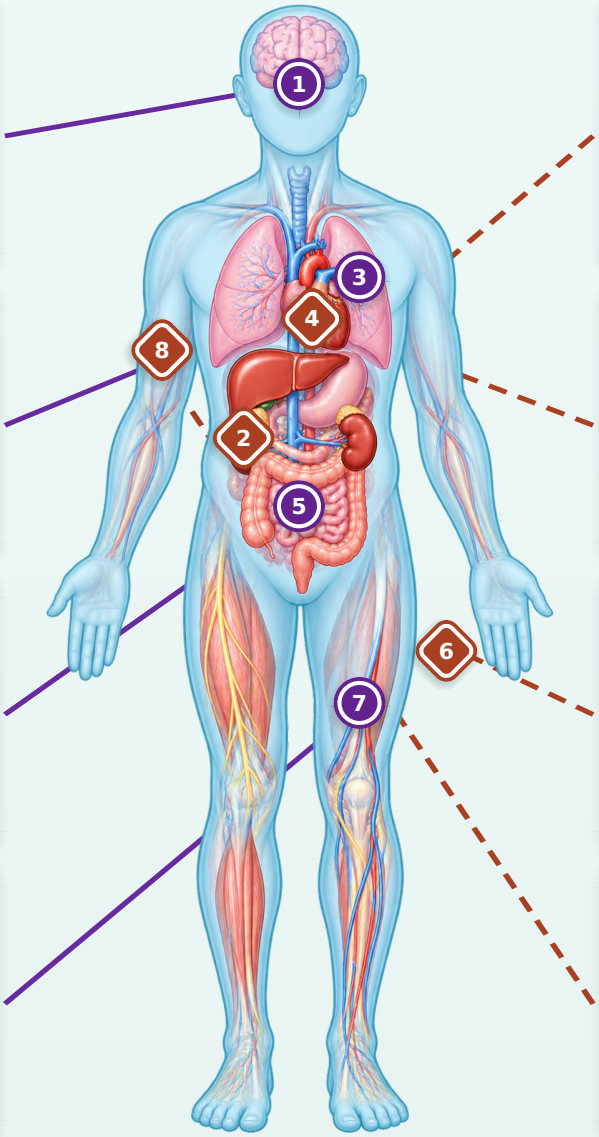
Cetuximab

New breathing difficulty requires prompt assessment.

4 Infusion symptoms

Cetuximab

Tell the nurse immediately about itching, swelling or flushing.



5 Bowel

Treatment

Diarrhoea, increased stoma output or dehydration: call early.

6 Skin / nails

Cetuximab

Report painful rash, cracks or infected skin early.

7 Blood / infection

Treatment

Fever, shivers or sudden illness: contact oncology immediately.

8 Infusion access

Treatment delivery

Pain, swelling, leakage or a loose connection needs immediate advice.

Selected effects, not every possible effect or a prediction. Blood-count, skin and line markers are schematic. Number and text carry meaning; colour is decorative.

Fever, shivers or suddenly unwell: contact oncology immediately. Severe chest pain, breathing difficulty, collapse or seizure: 112 / 999.

Your treatment, at home.

Important medicine-specific effects

Cetuximab

- Rash, dry skin, cracks and sore nails
- Eye inflammation or corneal injury
- Low magnesium, calcium or potassium
- Diarrhoea, dehydration and kidney problems
- Infusion reaction; rare serious lung or skin effects

Head-and-neck indication only: cetuximab starts one week before radiation, then continues alongside it. See the course graphic.

Surgery, radiation and monitoring: open the whole-treatment map or scan the QR.

Make the plan practical

First cetuximab dose

Skin care and sun protection under local EGFR policy. First two doses require post-infusion observation; delayed-reaction education. Monthly electrolytes/Mg/Ca for two months after last dose.

Subsequent weekly cetuximab

Premedication continues for subsequent infusions. Head/neck RT requires separate mucosal, skin, swallow and nutrition support. Post-treatment monthly electrolytes/Mg/Ca for two months.

Emergency: 112 / 999. Severe breathing difficulty, collapse, seizure or severe chest pain needs emergency help.

Contact oncology immediately for temperature ≥37.5°C or ≤36°C, shivering or suddenly feeling unwell, even with a normal temperature. Follow your own hospital's instructions. If you cannot reach the team, seek urgent medical assessment.

YOUR ONCOLOGY TEAM · DAYTIME

Insert numbers here

Acute Oncology Service

YOUR ONCOLOGY TEAM · OUT OF HOURS

Insert numbers here

Ask for medical oncology

EVENINGS / OVERNIGHT

Your out-of-hours pathway / nearest ED

Other hospitals: use the numbers your team provides.

Complete reference, visual timeline and passport

https://sactcheck.com/patient/00207/

Sources and review status are available online. Follow your own prescription and hospital instructions.